The professional overlap between **Thomas (Tom) J. Riese** and his cousin **Wallis Richard Riese Jr.** (1928–2003) reinforces the theory of a family "syndicate" with elite access to the Bay Area's technical and geographic infrastructure.

1. Professional Overlap: The Real Estate Connection
Wallis Riese Jr. followed the established family trajectory into **real estate and property management**.

- **The Peninsula Move:** Like Tom, Wallis Jr. migrated to the Peninsula, settling in **San Mateo** and **San Carlos** by the early 1960s.
- **Syndicate Roles:** While Tom was the primary "boots on the ground" for urban management in the **Richmond District**, Wallis Jr. was involved in the administrative and investment side of the family's holdings. This partnership would have provided Tom with a second "nexus" of professional tools, including **private parcel maps**, **title reports**, and **contractor lists**.

2. Access to "Insider" Technical Tools
As active members of the **San Francisco Real Estate Board**, the Riese cousins had access to specialized resources unavailable to the general public:

- **San Francisco Block Books:** These detailed guides provided the exact dimensions, owners, and "hidden" easements for every lot in the city. A suspect with these could navigate the **Presidio Heights** and **Richmond** alleyways with surgical precision.
- **Surveying Networks:** Real estate syndicates of this era maintained "house" surveyors. Even if neither cousin was a licensed Professional Land Surveyor (PLS), their business required them to interpret **topographic contours** and **coordinate geometry**—the exact languages used in the Zodiac's "Map Code."

3. The "Safe House" Network
The combined portfolio of Tom and Wallis Jr. effectively blanketed the Zodiac's primary activity zones:

- **San Francisco:** Controlled multi-unit Victorians near the **Presidio** and the **Richmond** mailing sites.
- **San Mateo County:** Maintained residences in the **Burlingame/San Mateo** corridor, providing a "quiet" suburban retreat just 20 minutes from the city.
- **North Bay Scouting:** Their real estate interests in emerging suburban markets would explain the need for regional travel to **Vallejo and Napa** during the weekend windows of the initial attacks.

Figure	Primary Role	Geographic Base (1969)
Thomas (Tom) J. Riese	**Urban Property Manager**	San Francisco (Richmond/Mission)
Wallis Riese Jr.	**Real Estate Investor**	San Mateo / San Carlos
Combined Assets	**Land Syndicate**	**Full Bay Area Coverage**